IMPORTANT TERMINOLOGIES IN HUMAN DEVELOPMENT

Growth: It is defined as physical changes in body size, structure, bodily dimensions and increase in magnitude, muscular strength and organs.

Development: It is a progressive series of changes in an orderly, coherent pattern whereby an individual adapts to their environment. Development includes physical characteristics (height, weight), intellectual functions (creativity, performance of intelligence) and social characteristics (independence, aggressiveness).

Maturation: It is development of the organism as a function of time or age; it refers to neuro physiological and biochemical changes such as the time a child's teeth erupts, the child's developing ability to talk, walk etc.

Learning and Experience: It is any relatively permanent changes in thought, feeling and behaviour caused by interaction with the environment.

Maturation and Learning Interrelation: Learning and maturation cannot be isolated from each other. Development is the result of interaction of maturation and learning. This is clear in motor development especially in postural responses, locomotion and manipulation. In summary, development is a multifaceted and complex process, involving gains and losses, growth and aging and more are brought about by both maturation and learning.

of science called "Human Development" emerged in the twentieth century in order to understand the patterns of development from conception to the period of old age.

In this chapter on human development we will be able to understand the stages in the life span of a human being, the developmental changes and developmental tasks in each stage starting from prenatal stage to old age.

2.2 DOMAINS AND STAGES OF DEVELOPMENT

Physical Development: It includes the growth of the body and its organs during childhood, the appearance of physical signs of aging during adulthood, and the gains and losses in motor abilities that occur over the years.

Motor Development: Motor development refers to the development of a child's bones, muscles and ability to move around and manipulate his or her environment. Motor development can be divided into two sections: gross motor development and fine motor development.

- Gross motor development involves the movement of the large muscles in the child's body. This movement including sitting, walking, running and climbing stairs.
- Fine motor development are those that involve the small movements of the fingers and hands. They include picking

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